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| <b>GI APPLICANT NO.</b> | 02         |
| <b>DATE RECEIVED</b>    | 06/01/2026 |
| <b>DATE MAILED</b>      | 01/12/2026 |

## IDENTIFY QUALIFYING PRODUCT

### TECHNICAL SPECIFICATIONS

Technical Specifications outline the exact chemical, biological, and physical parameters that the agricultural product must satisfy to qualify for official certification and quality assurance. This includes detailed metrics regarding maximum moisture content, allowable size variations of the harvested goods, and strict limits on chemical residues or defects per batch. Maintaining these rigorous technical baselines guarantees a uniform standard of excellence, ensuring that every certified item leaving the production facility meets the expectations of premium commercial markets.

### PROOF LINK

Proof of Link establishes the definitive, causal relationship between the specific qualities of the agricultural product and the distinct geographical environment where it is cultivated. This section provides scientific data and historical documentation demonstrating how the unique soil composition, microclimate, and local farming traditions directly create the characteristic flavor, aroma, or texture of the harvest. Without establishing this undeniable environmental connection, a product cannot legally claim geographic exclusivity or be protected against generic market imitations.

### AREA OF PRODUCTION

Geographical Origin details trace these beans back to the high-elevation, volcanic soil of Lipa City and surrounding municipalities in Batangas, where the microclimate is perfectly suited for Liberica cultivation. The unique terroir, characterized by rich minerals and distinct wet and dry seasons, plays a crucial role in shaping the coffee's complex characteristics.

Advantages also include the ideal sloping terrain of the region, which provides excellent water drainage for the coffee trees. This specific environment allows the roots to absorb optimal nutrients from the historic volcanic ash, giving the crop a flavor that cannot be replicated anywhere else in the world.

### DISTINCTIVE QUALITY

Distinctive Quality markers set Lipa Barako Coffee apart from other local brews, notably its high resistance to pests and its exceptionally potent, lingering aftertaste. It is widely celebrated not just as a beverage, but as a symbol of Filipino resilience and traditional coffee culture that has survived global market shifts.

Proven by its rare bean shape, which features a unique hook at one end that is entirely characteristic of the true Liberica species. This physical trait, combined with its dense cellular structure, allows it to retain its potent flavor and essential oils much longer than standard coffee varieties.

### INSPECTION

Inspection designates the independent, accredited authority responsible for conducting regular audits, field checks, and laboratory testing to verify strict compliance with established production standards. This regulatory entity monitors the entire supply chain—from the initial planting and harvesting phases to processing, packaging, and distribution—to prevent fraud and maintain consumer trust. By enforcing unbiased quality control, this organization ensures that all participating farmers strictly adhere to the certified protocols required for geographical protection.

## **AROMA**

Aroma characteristics are immediate and unmistakable, releasing a powerful, deeply sweet, and pungent fragrance the moment the beans are ground or brewed. The scent is heavily reminiscent of dark brown sugar, roasted nuts, and a distinct wood smoke that fills the room, signaling the brew's intense strength.

## **LABELING REQUIREMENTS**

Production Technique standards dictate a meticulous process that combines time-honored farming methods with carefully controlled post-harvest treatments, including selective hand-picking of only the ripest coffee cherries. The beans undergo a specialized medium-to-dark roasting process designed specifically for the large, dense structure of the Liberica bean, ensuring even heat distribution without charring the outer layers. This artisanal approach effectively caramelizes the natural sugars and locks in the essential oils, resulting in the signature glossy appearance and robust flavor of the final brew.

## **FARMING PRACTICES**

Labeling Requirements specify the mandatory visual elements, logos, and traceability data that must be clearly displayed on the final retail packaging of the certified product. This includes the prominent placement of the official Geographical Indication seal, the registered name of the product, batch tracking numbers, and clear instructions regarding proper storage conditions. These strict packaging guidelines prevent consumer confusion, protect the authentic brand identity in global markets, and allow inspectors to verify legitimacy at a glance.

I declare that all the information provided above are true and correct to the best of my knowledge.

ARNOLD MALBATAAN

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SIGNATURE OVER PRINTED NAME